

A FRAMEWORK IN CHAPTERS

Chapter Seven

Enclosure

*The privatisation of access to resources
required for living*

Enclosure is the system that privatises access to resources required for living — originally land, extended to housing, water, healthcare, food systems, knowledge, and data. This chapter runs it through the five domains — from the Land Use Act 1978 to the prepaid electricity meter to the slow death of the patient who cannot afford treatment.

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CHAPTER 7 OF AN ONGOING FRAMEWORK

Enclosure

Enclosure is the sixth Fundamental Matrix. The framework's own outline defines it as the privatisation of access to resources required for living — originally land, extended to housing, water, healthcare, food systems, knowledge, data, and any other material or condition required for the subject's current living conditions.

Enclosure is a constituent of the Capitalism intersection (the Intersectional Matrices chapter combines Enclosure + Productivism + Rankism + State Sovereignty). This chapter studies Enclosure on its own terms. The intersection returns when those four constituents are read together — Enclosure supplies the 'private property' infrastructure that the others depend on.

A note on method. The Interpersonal, Disciplinary, and Structural sections take the naive approach — each triad described as if happening for the first time, with no networks, residues, or Canon referenced. The Hegemonic Domain section is where Canon and Practice finally enter the picture.

READING NOTE

Same convention as Chapters 1 through 6. Every paragraph is written to be tweetable. Where you see literal blanks (____), the framework is asking you to write yourself into it. The blanks are the difference between reading about Enclosure and locating yourself inside it.

Contents

Enclosure	1
Contents	1
1. Definition: What Enclosure Extracts, Enforces, and Removes	3
1.1 What Enclosure Extracts	3
1.2 What Enclosure Enforces	4
1.3 What Options Enclosure Removes	4
2. The Interpersonal Domain	5
3.1 Enforcement Triad: Private Property Standard	5
3.2 Enforcement Triad: Rent Relationship Standard	5
3.3 Enforcement Triad: Wage Relationship Standard	6
3.4 Enforcement Triad: Eviction / Displacement Standard	6
3.5 Enforcement Triad: Subscription / Terms Standard	7

3.6 Extraction Triad: Rent	7
3.7 Extraction Triad: Profit	8
3.8 Extraction Triad: Interest	8
3.9 Extraction Triad: Labour to Afford Access	9
3.10 Extraction Triad: Time to Afford Access	9
3. The Disciplinary Domain	11
4.1 Disciplinary Hierarchy — Nested Stars	11
4.2 Disciplinary Community — Distributed Network	12
4. The Structural Domain	14
5.1 Bureaucracy — Enduring Rules and Procedures	14
5.2 Stratification — Enduring Zero-Sum Rankings	14
5.3 Classification — Enduring Categorical Divisions	15
5. The Hegemonic Domain: The Ascension Ritual	16
6.1 Canon — Rewriting History	16
6.2 Practice — Rewriting Reality	17
6. When Did Enclosure Rewrite History?	20
7. Fill in the Blank: A Self-Examination	21
Question 1: When did Enclosure rewrite your reality?	21
Question 2: How is Enclosure causing your Death?	21
8. Endnotes & References	22
Coming Next	23

SECTION 1

1. Definition: What Enclosure Extracts, Enforces, and Removes

Enclosure is the system that privatises access to resources required for living. The term draws on Karl Polanyi's *The Great Transformation* (1944), which traced the 18th- and 19th-century enclosure of common land in England as the foundational act of capitalist modernity. Polanyi showed that land, labour, and money were 'fictitious commodities' — not produced for sale but treated as if they were.

E. P. Thompson's *Customs in Common* (1991) documented the moral economy of the English crowd that resisted enclosure. Karl Marx's *Capital* Vol. 1 (1867) called the process 'primitive accumulation' — the historical violence by which common resources were converted into private property. David Harvey, in *The New Imperialism* (2003), updated the analysis as 'accumulation by dispossession,' showing that enclosure is not a one-time event but an ongoing feature of capitalism.

Silvia Federici, in *Caliban and the Witch* (2004), showed that enclosure was a gendered project: the enclosure of common land dispossessed women of the reproductive base of their autonomy, and the witch hunts of the 16th and 17th centuries terrorised women into the new reproductive regime. Peter Linebaugh's *The Magna Carta Manifesto* (2008) traced the loss of common rights to subsistence. Arturo Escobar's *Pluriversal Politics* (2020) frames enclosure as the ontological violence that reduces a pluriverse of ways of living to a single capitalist reality.

Elinor Ostrom's *Governing the Commons* (1990) decisively refuted the 'tragedy of the commons' argument that Garrett Hardin had made in 1968. Ostrom showed empirically that common-pool resources can be governed sustainably by communities without enclosure. The framework adopts Ostrom's refutation: enclosure is not a solution to scarcity. It is a cause of scarcity.

1.1 What Enclosure Extracts

Enclosure extracts five things. First, **rent**: the payment the tenant makes to the property owner for access to land, housing, or equipment. The rent is paid in money, in sharecropping arrangements, in kind, or in labour.

Second, **profit**: the surplus the owner extracts from the worker's labour, above the wage. The surplus is the difference between what the worker produces and what the worker receives. Third, **interest**: the payment the debtor makes to the creditor for the use of money over time. The interest is the price of access to capital.

Fourth, **the labour required to afford access**: the hours, days, and years the subject spends working to earn the rent, the fee, the bill, the subscription. This extraction is invisible because it is performed as 'making a living.' Fifth, **the time required to afford access**: the queue, the paperwork, the

commute, the navigation of bureaucracy that the subject performs to maintain access.

1.2 What Enclosure Enforces

Enclosure enforces five standards. First, **private property as natural**: the assumption that private ownership of land, housing, water, healthcare, food, knowledge, and data is the natural order, and that common ownership is deviant.

Second, the **rent relationship**: the tenant must pay rent or be evicted. The rent relationship is the basic structure of access to housing. Third, the **wage relationship as the only route to access**: the subject must work for wages to afford rent, food, healthcare, education, and data. The wage is the only permitted route to the resources required for living.

Fourth, the **eviction as punishment**: the subject who cannot pay is evicted, disconnected, cut off, or deported. The eviction is the enforcement. Fifth, the **displacement as consequence**: the subject who is evicted is displaced — from the house, from the neighbourhood, from the city, from the country. The displacement is the consequence.

1.3 What Options Enclosure Removes

Concretely, Enclosure removes the option of common land. The Land Use Act 1978 vests all land in state governors, who hold it in trust for the people. In practice, the Act has converted customary land tenure — in which lineages held land in trust for their members and granted use-rights — into a system of Certificate of Occupancy that requires state approval and payment.

It removes the option of free water. The Lagos State Water Corporation charges for piped water. The borehole is private. The river is polluted by oil extraction in the Niger Delta, by industrial waste in Lagos, and by agricultural runoff across the country. The subject who cannot pay for water drinks what they can find.

It removes the option of free healthcare. The Structural Adjustment Programme of 1986 imposed user fees on public hospitals. Before SAP, public hospitals provided free healthcare. After SAP, the patient who cannot pay is turned away, sometimes to die. It removes the option of free education. The Universal Basic Education Act 2004 guarantees free basic education, but hidden fees (PTA levies, examination fees, uniform costs) make the ‘free’ education expensive.

It removes the option of free knowledge. The academic publishing industry paywalls research that was often publicly funded. The Copyright Act protects the rights of publishers over the rights of readers. The Alaba, Computer Village, and Onitsha main market piracy networks are the informal commons that has emerged against the paywall, but the formal system remains enclosed. It removes the option of free data. The telecoms companies charge for data by the gigabyte, and the subject who cannot pay is disconnected. Each removal is enforced by law, by the bailiff, and by the triads below.

SECTION 2 · NAIVE APPROACH

2. The Interpersonal Domain

The Interpersonal Domain contains five enforcement triads and five extraction triads. Each is described here as if happening for the first time — no networks, no residues, no Canon. Just the act, the conforming subject, the complicit witness, and (for extraction triads) the Non-Extracting Beneficiary.

3.1 Enforcement Triad: Private Property Standard

The enforcer is the person who invokes private ownership to deny access. The landlord who refuses the tenant's guest. The property owner who calls the police on the trespasser. The company that sues the photographer for taking a picture of its building. The enforcement is performed by direct invocation, by physical removal, by legal action, or by police intervention.

The subject conforms by leaving, by paying, by asking permission, or by forgoing access. The conforming act is the absence of access — the subject does not enter, does not use, does not photograph. The conforming act is the body turned away.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The homeless person who is removed from the empty building loses the option to shelter, which is to say, loses the option to bodily safety. The forager who is prosecuted for picking fruit loses the option to food. The photographer who is sued for the picture loses the option to document. The traveller who is refused access to land loses the option to passage.

The witness is the person who watches the invocation of private property and says nothing, or who themselves invoke private property in their own claims. The witness's complicity normalises the demand. The witness who says 'it's their property' is closing the loop.

3.2 Enforcement Triad: Rent Relationship Standard

The enforcer is the person who demands rent as the condition of access to housing, land, or equipment. The landlord who demands monthly rent. The landowner who demands a share of the harvest. The equipment owner who demands a hire fee. The enforcement is performed by direct demand, by withholding access, or by evicting the non-paying subject.

The subject conforms by paying. The conforming act is the payment itself — the money, the harvest share, the labour. The payment is the proof of the system. The subject who cannot pay is the subject who is evicted.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The tenant who must pay 60% of income in rent loses the option to save, which is to say, loses the option to economic security. The tenant who cannot pay loses the option to shelter, which is to say, loses the option to bodily safety. The sharecropper who must give half the harvest to the landowner loses the option to feed their family adequately.

The witness is the person who watches the rent demand and says nothing, or who themselves pay rent and so model compliance. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the landlord's family member who lives in the building rent-free, consuming the tenant's rent as building maintenance, without personally commanding the rent.

3.3 Enforcement Triad: Wage Relationship Standard

The enforcer is the person who demands wage labour as the only route to access. The employer who demands the worker perform labour for wages. The state that demands the citizen prove employment for benefits. The family that demands the young person 'get a job.' The enforcement is performed by withholding access to money, by withholding social standing, or by punishing the unemployed.

The subject conforms by working for wages. The conforming act is the labour itself — the hours, days, and years spent in employment. The wage is the proof of the system. The subject who does not work for wages is the subject who is unemployed, deviant, and excluded.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The worker who must work 60 hours a week to afford rent loses the option to rest, which is to say, loses the option to bodily recovery. The worker who must work in dangerous conditions loses the option to bodily safety. The creative person who cannot monetise their work loses the option to a livelihood, because there is no permitted route to subsistence outside the wage.

The witness is the person who watches the wage demand and says nothing, or who themselves work for wages and so model compliance. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the worker's family member who consumes the wage — the spouse who does not work, the child who is in school — without personally commanding the labour.

3.4 Enforcement Triad: Eviction / Displacement Standard

The enforcer is the person who performs or threatens eviction. The landlord who serves the quit notice. The developer who hires the bulldozer. The state that demolishes the informal settlement. The bank that forecloses on the mortgage. The utility that disconnects the service. The enforcement is performed by the quit notice, by the demolition, by the disconnection, or by the bailiff.

The subject conforms by leaving. The conforming act is the body's departure — the subject packs, moves, finds another place, becomes homeless, or dies. The departure is the proof of the system. There is no argument to make against a demolition that has already happened.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The tenant who is evicted loses the option to shelter, which is to say, loses the option to a stable life. The resident of the informal settlement that is demolished loses the option to community, which is to say, loses the option to social support. The worker who is displaced loses the option to livelihood, which is to say, loses the option to subsistence.

The witness is the person who watches the eviction and says nothing, or who themselves model compliance by paying their own rent on time. The witness's complicity is the shared acceptance that

eviction is the natural consequence of non-payment.

3.5 Enforcement Triad: Subscription / Terms Standard

The enforcer is the person or institution that demands subscription, login, or terms-of-service agreement as the condition of access. The platform that demands the user create an account. The publisher that paywalls the article. The telecom that charges for data. The bank that requires the BVN. The state that requires the NIN. The enforcement is performed by the login wall, by the paywall, by the data charge, by the suspension of service, or by the legal action for breach of terms.

The subject conforms by subscribing, logging in, paying the data charge, agreeing to the terms. The conforming act is the click — the user clicks ‘I agree,’ the user enters their password, the user pays the subscription. The click is the proof of the system. The consent is performed without reading, because the alternative is non-access.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The user who cannot afford the subscription loses the option to the content. The user who refuses the terms loses the option to the service. The user whose data runs out loses the option to communication. The citizen who refuses the NIN loses the option to a bank account, a SIM card, a voter card, a passport — the option to legal existence in the modern Nigerian state.

The witness is the person who watches the subscription demand and says nothing, or who themselves subscribe and so model compliance. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the family member who uses the subscriber’s account — the spouse who watches Netflix on the partner’s subscription, the child who uses the parent’s data — without personally paying.

3.6 Extraction Triad: Rent

The extractor is the property owner who requires payment for access to land, housing, or equipment. The landlord who collects monthly rent. The landowner who collects a share of the harvest. The equipment owner who collects a hire fee. The intellectual property owner who collects royalties. The extraction is performed by direct demand, by lease agreement, or by eviction of the non-paying subject.

The subject conforms by paying. What is extracted is tangible: money, harvest, labour. The extraction transfers resources from the subject to the owner. If nothing tangible transfers, it is not this triad. The rent is the purest expression of Enclosure: the subject pays for access to something the owner did not produce.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Lagos tenant who pays 800,000 naira a year for a room loses the option to save, which is to say, loses the option to economic mobility. The Abuja tenant who pays 2.5 million naira a year for a flat loses the option to invest in their children’s education. The market trader who pays 5,000 naira a day in stall fees loses the option to rest, because rest means losing the day’s fee.

The witness is the person who knows of the rent extraction and does not intervene, or who themselves pay rent to their own landlord. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the landlord's family who consume the rent as building maintenance, school fees, and lifestyle — without personally commanding the rent. This role is unstable: the moment the family member begins to demand rent from their own tenants, they become extractors.

3.7 Extraction Triad: Profit

The extractor is the owner who extracts the surplus of the worker's labour. The factory owner who pays the worker a wage worth less than the value of what the worker produces. The farm owner who pays the labourer a fraction of the value of the harvest. The service company owner who pays the employee a fraction of the value of the contract. The extraction is performed by the wage relation itself — the worker is paid less than the value of their labour.

The subject conforms by working. What is extracted is the surplus value — the difference between what the worker produces and what the worker receives. The extraction is invisible to the worker because the wage appears as fair exchange. The worker does not see the surplus because the surplus is realised by the owner after the worker has gone home.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The factory worker who produces goods worth 50,000 naira a day and is paid 5,000 naira loses the option to the products of their own labour, which is to say, loses the option to a life commensurate with their productivity. The domestic worker who cleans a house for 20,000 naira a month loses the option to a wage that would let them clean their own house properly. The graduate who earns 150,000 naira a month at a multinational that bills their labour at 1.5 million naira loses the option to economic independence.

The witness is the person who watches the profit extraction and does not intervene, or who themselves employ workers. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the consumer who buys the product at a price that reflects the owner's profit margin but does not personally command the wage extraction.

3.8 Extraction Triad: Interest

The extractor is the creditor who requires interest on loans. The bank that charges 25% on a personal loan, the microfinance institution that charges 5% a month. The informal moneylender who charges 20% a week. The supplier who offers credit at a price. The state that charges late-payment penalties on taxes and utilities. The extraction is performed by the loan agreement, by the credit offer, or by the legal action for default.

The subject conforms by paying. What is extracted is tangible: money. The extraction transfers resources from the debtor to the creditor over time. The interest compounds. The debtor who borrows 100,000 naira at 25% a year and pays the minimum will pay 100,000 naira in interest in four years, on top of the principal.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The borrower who takes a 500,000 naira business loan at 5% a month loses the option to grow the business, because the interest absorbs the profit. The

borrower who defaults loses the option to credit, to a bank account, sometimes to physical safety — moneylenders in Lagos have been known to seize property and threaten violence. The debtor who is imprisoned under the imprisonment-for-debt laws loses the option to liberty.

The witness is the person who knows of the interest extraction and does not intervene, or who themselves lend money at interest. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the bank's depositor who earns a fraction of the interest the bank charges — the depositor benefits from the extraction without personally commanding it.

3.9 Extraction Triad: Labour to Afford Access

The extractor is the system that requires the subject to work to afford access to resources required for living. The rent that requires 60% of the wage. The school fees that require 20%. The medical bills that require whatever is left. The data charges that require a top-up. The transport fare that requires the daily wage. The extraction is performed by the price of access itself — the subject must work to pay.

The subject conforms by working. What is extracted is the labour — the hours, days, and years the subject spends in employment to afford access. The labour is invisible as extraction because it is performed as 'making a living.' The worker does not see the extraction because the wage appears as fair exchange.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The worker who must work 60 hours a week to afford rent loses the option to rest, which is to say, loses the option to bodily recovery. The worker who must work two jobs to afford school fees loses the option to time with their children, which is to say, loses the option to parenthood. The worker who must work through illness to afford the medical bill loses the option to recovery, which is to say, loses the option to a body that is not already worn out.

The witness is the person who watches the labour-to-afford extraction and does not intervene, or who themselves work to afford access. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the employer who benefits from the worker's desperate compliance — the worker cannot refuse the wage because the worker cannot refuse the rent — without personally commanding the rent.

3.10 Extraction Triad: Time to Afford Access

The extractor is the system that requires the subject to spend time navigating bureaucracy to access resources. The queue at the public hospital. The paperwork for the Certificate of Occupancy. The commute to the office. The wait at the bank. The hold on the phone. The verification process for the BVN. The registration process for the NIN. The extraction is performed by the bureaucracy itself — the subject must spend the time to access.

The subject conforms by waiting. What is extracted is the time itself — the hours, days, and weeks the subject spends in queue, in paperwork, in commute, in verification. The extraction is silent. There is no envelope, no tribute. There is only the subject's lost afternoon, lost week, lost year.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The patient who waits six hours at the public hospital loses the option to a day's wage, which is to say, loses the option to a day's food. The citizen who spends three days at the NIN registration centre loses the option to work, which is to say, loses the option to economic stability. The commuter who spends four hours a day in Lagos traffic loses the option to rest, which is to say, loses the option to a body that is not already exhausted by 8am.

The witness is the person who waits alongside the subject, or who watches the waiting and says nothing. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the person who bypasses the queue through connection — the wealthy patient who sees the doctor immediately, the connected citizen whose NIN is processed in a day — without personally commanding the queue.

Nascent forms of this system include: 'This is private property', 'No trespassing', 'Pay rent or leave', 'Show your title', 'This land belongs to my family', 'You can't sleep here', 'Buy or get out', 'Get a job', 'No free lunch', 'Work for your keep', 'Don't drink the tap water', 'Don't swim in the river', 'Don't pick the fruit', 'Don't forage', 'No loitering', 'Pay the bill or be cut off', 'You must pay for school', 'You must pay for healthcare', 'Pay-per-view' / 'pay-per-use', 'Subscription required', 'Paywall', 'Login required', 'This content is for members only', 'Subscribe for full access', 'Data charges may apply', 'Turn off your data', 'The cloud costs money', 'Your subscription has expired', 'Your account has been suspended', 'Upgrade to premium', 'Terms and conditions apply', 'I agree to the terms', 'This is my land / house / water / food', 'This neighbourhood is for owners only', 'Gated community', 'Members only'.

SECTION 3 · NAIVE APPROACH

3. The Disciplinary Domain

When the ten triads above link into networks, Enclosure scales. The link can be hierarchical (the enforcer at one level is the subject at the level above) or community-based (the witness at one triad becomes the enforcer at another). Both forms are visible in every Nigerian institution that organises property, work, and access.

4.1 Disciplinary Hierarchy — Nested Stars

A Disciplinary Hierarchy is a chain of nested triads. The enforcer at one level is the subject at the level above. Each middle position is simultaneously subject above and enforcer below. Enclosure spreads through this form in every Nigerian institution with a property-based chain of command.

Peak Triad-Node

At the peak is the triad where the highest property authority in the hierarchy enforces on the layer below. The peak enforcer is almost always an owner or a senior creditor, because Enclosure ranks owners at the top. The peak extracts rent, profit, interest, and labour-to-afford-access from the layer below, and enforces private property, rent relationship, wage relationship, eviction, and subscription on everyone.

In the land hierarchy, the peak triad is the Presidency enforcing on state governors (who hold land in trust under the Land Use Act). In the banking hierarchy, the peak is the CBN Governor enforcing on commercial bank MDs. In the corporate hierarchy, the peak is the CEO enforcing on Directors. In the university hierarchy, the peak is the Vice Chancellor enforcing on the layer below. In the hospital hierarchy, the peak is the Chief Medical Director enforcing on the layer below.

Middle Triad-Nodes

The middle nodes are where the chain's character is clearest. Each middle enforcer is simultaneously subject above and enforcer below. The branch manager who kneels for the MD in the morning demands kneeling from the loan officer in the afternoon. The Director who defers to the CEO at the board meeting demands deference from the Manager at the office meeting.

The middle is where Enclosure reproduces. The middle position teaches the subject to want the position above, which means learning to enforce on those below. By the time the worker becomes a manager, they have been disciplined by Enclosure for decades. The bank's middle manager, who was once a loan officer subject to the branch manager's enforcement, now enforces on the loan officer — with the accumulated pressure of two decades of being enforced on.

Bottom Triad-Node

At the bottom is the triad where the lowest-ranked owner or creditor enforces on the most vulnerable subject. The small landlord enforcing on the tenant. The microfinance institution enforcing on the market trader. The casual worker's supervisor enforcing on the casual worker. The hospital's billing officer enforcing on the patient who cannot pay. The telecom's disconnection system enforcing on the user whose data has run out. The bottom is where the system's violence is most concentrated.

The bottom node is also where the hierarchy meets the community form. The small landlord who enforces on the tenant is simultaneously the subject of the bank's mortgage enforcement. The market trader who is enforced on by the microfinance lender simultaneously enforces on their own apprentice. The intersection of hierarchy and community is what makes Enclosure inescapable — the subject is enforced on at work and enforces at home.

4.2 Disciplinary Community — Distributed Network

A Disciplinary Community is a distributed network. There is no peak, no chain of command. There is only circulation. The witness of one Enclosure triad becomes the enforcer, subject, or witness of another. Enclosure spreads laterally through any person who has witnessed property enforcement without dissenting.

Landlords' Associations

The landlords' association is the textbook Enclosure community. Landlords meet and share enforcement techniques. The landlord who has successfully raised rent on a tenant teaches the technique to the landlord who has not. The landlord who has successfully evicted a non-paying tenant shares the lawyer's contact. The pattern circulates.

Property Developers and Bankers' Networks

The property developers' network and the Bankers' Committee are formal community networks. The developers coordinate land acquisition, demolition, and construction schedules. The bankers coordinate interest rates, fees, and credit policies. The coordination is not illegal price-fixing in the formal sense; it is the shared understanding of how the Enclosure system works. No central command issues the order. The pattern circulates.

University and Hospital Networks

The Committee of Vice Chancellors and the Nigerian Medical Association are community networks that circulate Enclosure practices. The VCs share fee structures, admission criteria, and strategies for managing student protests. The NMA shares billing practices and strategies for managing patient complaints. Both networks reproduce the enclosure of education and healthcare.

Telecoms Coordination

The telecoms companies coordinate through the NCC. MTN, Glo, Airtel, and 9mobile share the practice of data expiration, of subscription auto-renewal, of 'fair use' policies that throttle consumption. The coordination is not formal price-fixing; it is the shared understanding of how the data enclosure works. No consumer is consulted.

Intellectual Property Enforcement

The Nigerian Copyright Commission (NCC) and the anti-piracy raids at Alaba International Market, Computer Village, and Onitsha main market are community enforcement of the enclosure of knowledge. The raids criminalise the informal commons of pirated music, films, and software that has emerged against the paywall. The paradox is that the piracy networks themselves violate the IP enclosure while enforcing their own enclosure of distribution — the pirate who copies the film owns the copy until the buyer pays. The framework treats both moves as analytically legible.

The Eviction Mob

The most violent form of Enclosure community is the eviction mob. The Otodo Gbame evictions of 2016 and 2017 in Lagos displaced over 30,000 residents. The Makoko evictions of 2012 and 2021 displaced thousands more. The Maroko eviction of 1990 displaced 300,000. Each was performed by a combination of state agents, private developers, and hired thugs. Each was a community enforcement event — ordinary workers, police officers, and bulldozer drivers acting as the witness-become-enforcer.

The framework treats these events as analytically legible: they are the community form of Enclosure doing what communities do when the witness stops being complicit and becomes the enforcer. The demolition is the triad scaled to a mob. The bulldozer is the eviction notice made of steel.

SECTION 4 · NAIVE APPROACH

4. The Structural Domain

Run the Ship of Theseus test. When the people in the initial Enclosure triads are dead and replaced, when the networks are disbanded and reform, what is consistent? What outlives both individuals and groups? What forces new individuals and groups to re-form into the same patterns — not because anyone instructs them to, but because the residue makes any other pattern costly or invisible?

Enclosure leaves all three residues. It is one of the most total systems in the framework. Almost every Nigerian institution carries Bureaucracy, Stratification, and Classification from Enclosure simultaneously.

5.1 Bureaucracy — Enduring Rules and Procedures

Enclosure's bureaucracy is the codified property and access structure. The Land Use Act 1978 (a military decree by Obasanjo) vests all land in state governors, who hold it in trust for the people. The Certificate of Occupancy system requires state approval and payment for land use. The Land Registry codifies who owns what. The mortgage system (NHF, Federal Mortgage Bank) channels housing finance through formal institutions.

The tenancy laws of various states codify the landlord-tenant relationship. The eviction laws codify the procedure for removing non-paying tenants. The Companies and Allied Matters Act (CAMA) codifies corporate property. The Electricity Act 2023 and the prepaid meter system codify the enclosure of electricity. The Water Resources Bill (controversial, repeatedly introduced since 2018) would codify the enclosure of water.

The National Health Insurance Scheme (NHIS) Act 1999 codified the partial enclosure of healthcare, replacing the free public healthcare of the 1970s with a user-fee-plus-insurance model. The Universal Basic Education Act 2004 codified nominal free basic education while permitting PTA levies and other hidden fees. The Copyright Act codifies the enclosure of knowledge. The NCC (Nigerian Communications Commission) regulatory framework codifies the enclosure of data.

The Central Bank of Nigeria's financial inclusion framework codifies the enclosure of money through formal banking. The BVN (Bank Verification Number) codifies the enclosure of financial identity. The NIN (National Identification Number) codifies the enclosure of civic identity. The NDPR (Nigeria Data Protection Regulation) 2019 codifies the enclosure of data. The Cashless Policy codifies the enclosure of cash through digital rails. The original 1978 decree authors are dead or retired. The bureaucracy lives.

5.2 Stratification — Enduring Zero-Sum Rankings

Enclosure's stratification is the daily experience of property and access rank in every institutional encounter. **Owner/tenant** — the owner ranks above the tenant in housing security, in legal standing, in social recognition. **Employer/employee** — the employer ranks above the employee in control of the labour process, in the wage relation, in social standing.

Creditor/debtor — the creditor ranks above the debtor in financial security, in legal standing, in the power to seize assets. **Rich/poor in access to land, housing, healthcare, education, water, data** — the rich rank above the poor in every dimension of access. **Urban/rural in access to infrastructure** — the urban ranks above the rural in piped water, in electricity, in internet, in healthcare, in education.

Documented/undocumented in access to formal finance — the documented (BVN, NIN, passport) rank above the undocumented in bank access, in credit access, in legal recognition.

Connected/unconnected to the grid — the connected rank above the unconnected in electricity, in piped water, in internet, in mobile money. The ranking is in the air; it does not need to be announced.

The Lagos estate enforces stratification without anyone issuing an order. The owner lives in the main house. The tenant lives in the BQ (boys' quarters). The domestic worker lives in the 'servant's room.' The gatehouse is for the security guard. The seating is the rank. Challenging the seating is challenging the property order.

5.3 Classification — Enduring Categorical Divisions

Enclosure's classification is the set of categorical names that organise every Nigerian into property and access categories. **Private** and **public** — the universal pair, with private as the legitimate and public as the deficient. **Owned** and **rented** — the housing pair, with owned as the aspiration and rented as the temporary.

Employed and **unemployed** — the work pair, with employed as the legitimate and unemployed as the deviant. **Paid** and **unpaid** — the labour pair, with paid as the formal and unpaid as the informal (and predominantly female). **Formal** and **informal** — the sector pair, with formal as the legitimate and informal as the tolerated.

Documented and **undocumented** — the identity pair, with documented as the recognised and undocumented as the invisible. **Connected** and **disconnected** — the infrastructure pair, with connected as the served and disconnected as the unserved. **Premium** and **free** — the subscription pair, with premium as the full and free as the partial. **Member** and **non-member** — the community pair, with member as the inside and non-member as the outside.

The classification does the work before any individual enforcer shows up. A person walking into a bank to open an account is already classified; the officer may refuse service without the BVN. A person walking into a hospital is already classified; the billing officer may refuse treatment without the deposit. A person walking into a landlord's office is already classified; the landlord may refuse the tenancy without the year's rent in advance. Classification is the most universal structural residue. Enclosure's classification is the foundational binary — owner/non-owner — that organises almost every other classification in the framework.

SECTION 5

5. The Hegemonic Domain: The Ascension Ritual

Is Enclosure ascended? Yes on all three counts. It produces all three structural residues including Stratification (so Internalised Domination applies). It has working Canon and Practice mechanisms. The vast majority of Nigerians cannot imagine a society without private property, rent, wages, and user fees — despite the fact that pre-colonial Nigerian land tenure was communal, and the fact that public healthcare and education were free within living memory.

6.1 Canon — Rewriting History

Canon is the present belief that Enclosure has always been so. The origination of the structural residues — the Land Use Act 1978, the SAP 1986, the prepaid meter, the data charge, the BVN, the NIN, the NDPR — has been forgotten. The average Nigerian now takes the property and access structure as natural, eternal, and without alternative.

What is forgotten? Pre-colonial Nigerian land was held communally under lineage control, with individual use-rights but not alienable private property. The lineage held land in trust for its members. Use-rights could be granted, transferred, and inherited, but land could not be sold to a stranger without lineage consent. The Yoruba, Igbo, Hausa, Tiv, and other systems had variations on this communal tenure.

Also forgotten: that the Land Use Act 1978 was a military decree by Obasanjo that centralised land in state governors, displacing the customary land tenure systems. That public hospitals once provided free healthcare in the 1970s, before the Structural Adjustment Programme (SAP) of 1986 imposed user fees. That public universities once charged no tuition fees until the 1990s. That the prepaid electricity meter is a 2010s introduction that displaced the postpaid model. That the data-charge model for internet access is a 2000s introduction that displaced the landline era.

Also forgotten: that the BVN was introduced in 2014, the NIN in 2007 (with mass enrolment only from 2020), the NDPR in 2019, the Cashless Policy in 2012. Each of these enclosures was introduced within the last two decades. The Canon presents them as the natural order of modern life. The history shows them as recent impositions that the public has not consented to in any meaningful sense.

Internalised Domination

Canon produces Internalised Domination because Enclosure produces Stratification. The landlord's felt entitlement to rent increases and eviction is now natural, automatic, unquestionable. The landlord who raises the rent 30% at renewal does not experience this as a demand. They experience it as the market.

The employer's entitlement to the surplus of labour is natural. The bank's entitlement to interest is natural. The university's entitlement to fees is natural. The hospital's entitlement to bills is natural. The telecom's entitlement to data charges is natural. The state's entitlement to identity registration is natural. Each entitlement grows with repetition. The first time the landlord raised the rent, the tenant felt surprise. The hundredth time, the tenant feels resignation. The entitlement has been internalised so deeply that its non-fulfilment registers as the tenant's failure.

Internalised Authority

Canon produces Internalised Authority in the owner-enforcer regardless of personal material gain. The property owner who calls the police on the trespasser gains nothing material from the arrest. The call is the enforcement. The employer who disciplines the worker for 'slacking' gains nothing material from the discipline. The creditor who seizes the debtor's property gains nothing beyond what they were owed. The bailiff who enforces the eviction gains nothing material beyond their fee.

The NCC official who enforces data charges gains nothing material. The hospital billing officer who turns away the patient who cannot pay gains nothing material. The university bursar who refuses the student's registration for non-payment gains nothing material. The police officer who arrests the debtor under imprisonment-for-debt laws gains nothing material (the bribe is separate). The right to enforce feels natural, automatic, and legitimate. That is the Internalised Authority.

Internalised Oppression

Canon produces Internalised Oppression in the tenant, the employee, the debtor, the patient, the student, the user, the citizen. The tenant is taught that they cannot refuse a rent increase. The employee is taught that they cannot refuse a wage cut. The debtor is taught that they cannot refuse interest. The patient is taught that they cannot refuse a bill. The student is taught that they cannot refuse fees.

The user is taught that they cannot refuse data charges. The citizen is taught that they cannot refuse the BVN, the NIN, the NDPR consent. The teaching is silent; it is in the air. The tenant who is told by a fellow tenant 'that's the market' is being disciplined by Canon. The worker who is told by a colleague 'just be grateful you have a job' is being disciplined by Canon. Each internalises the impossibility of refusal.

The deepest form of this is the subject who has absorbed Enclosure so thoroughly that they enforce it on themselves. The tenant who says 'I should be grateful the landlord renewed' to explain why they accept the 30% increase. The worker who says 'I should be grateful I have a job' to explain why they accept the wage cut. The patient who says 'the hospital needs the money' to explain why they accept being turned away. The rebellion-capable subject has become the self-policing subject.

6.2 Practice — Rewriting Reality

Practice is the second mechanism of the Ascension Ritual. The interpersonal triad is repeated, again and again, until it becomes habit. The owner-enforcer forgets they can choose not to enforce. The tenant-subject forgets they can rebel. The witness forgets they can dissent. The middle-aged parent

who has been both subject and enforcer forgets they were ever either.

Pierre Bourdieu called this *habitus* — the sediment of repeated practice in the body. Silvia Federici, in *Caliban and the Witch* (2004) and *Re-enchanting the World* (2018), showed how the daily reproduction of capitalist relations is performed through the body of the subject — the worker who wakes at 5am, the tenant who pays the rent on the 1st, the patient who brings the deposit to the hospital. The body learns. The mind stops questioning.

By the time the Nigerian child is twelve, the rent relationship is reflex. They know the rent is paid on the 1st. They know the landlord must be greeted. They know the BQ is for tenants, not owners. By adulthood, the subject has performed the rent, wage, bill, fee, and subscription payments so many thousands of times that the alternative — refusing the rent, leaving the wage, defaulting on the bill — feels like a kind of amputation. The body has been trained. Practice has rewritten reality.

Death — Fast and Slow

Practice produces Death. Fast death in Enclosure is spectacular: the Maroko eviction of 1990 displaced 300,000 and killed an unknown number. The Makoko evictions of 2012 and 2021 displaced thousands. The Otodo Gbame evictions of 2016 and 2017 displaced over 30,000. The demolition of Nollywood film markets under anti-piracy raids. The police killing of electricity bill defaulters.

The hospital turning away patients who cannot pay — the pregnant woman turned away from the public hospital because she cannot pay the deposit, who dies in the transport to the next hospital. The debtor dying in prison under imprisonment-for-debt laws (technically abolished but still practised in modified form). The worker killed by exhaustion in a wage extraction system — the factory worker who collapsed at the machine, the domestic worker who died of sleep deprivation.

The forced eviction deaths — the resident who refused to leave and was buried under the demolition. The Boko Haram-displaced farmer killed by hunger in an IDP camp where food is rationed by NGOs because the common land that fed the farmer has been enclosed by the conflict. The Lagos demolitions under ‘beautification’ projects — the bulldozing of informal settlements to make way for shopping malls, with residents given hours to leave.

Slow death in Enclosure is quiet. Chronic stress from rent burden — the tenant who has not slept properly in years because the next rent payment is always approaching. Mental health collapse from debt — the debtor who has 18 loans and sees no way out. The worker ground down by wage extraction — the casual worker who has worked 12-hour days for 5 years and is now hypertensive at 35.

The patient whose condition worsens because they cannot afford treatment — the diabetic who cannot afford insulin, the cancer patient who cannot afford chemotherapy, the pregnant woman who cannot afford antenatal care. The student whose education is interrupted by fees — the undergraduate who has been sent home three times for non-payment and now doubts they will ever graduate. The user whose data runs out mid-conversation — the WhatsApp call that cuts, the email that cannot be sent, the job application that cannot be submitted.

The IDP whose food is rationed by NGOs because the common land is enclosed by conflict. The Ogoni farmer whose creek has been oiled for 40 years by Shell's extraction — the slow death of the environment that fed the farmer. The cumulative erosion of the commons that produces the climate crisis — the atmosphere enclosed by private emissions, the rivers enclosed by private pollution, the forests enclosed by private logging. The slow death of language and culture when knowledge is paywalled — the indigenous language that cannot be learned because the dictionary is paywalled, the traditional medicine that cannot be practised because the botanical knowledge is patented.

Ruth Wilson Gilmore's definition applies: Enclosure produces group-differentiated vulnerability to premature death. The groups are tenants, debtors, the unemployed, the undocumented, the unconnected, the patient who cannot pay, the student who cannot pay, the resident of the informal settlement, the resident of the Niger Delta. The premature death is fast (eviction, demolition, hospital refusal, debtor's prison, exhaustion) or slow (stress, debt, wage extraction, untreated illness, interrupted education, environmental poisoning). Every ascended matrix kills. Enclosure kills those whose access to resources does not fit the property model.

SECTION 6

6. When Did Enclosure Rewrite History?

The framework's historical question: when did Enclosure rewrite history in popular Nigerian living memory, such that the average Nigerian cannot recall a time when its structural residue was not present? This is not a history of how Enclosure was built. It is a diagnosis of when the building was forgotten.

Pre-colonial Nigerian land was held communally under lineage control. The Yoruba, Igbo, Hausa, Tiv, and other systems had variations on communal tenure, with individual use-rights but not alienable private property. Use-rights could be granted, transferred, and inherited, but land could not be sold to a stranger without lineage consent. The lineage held land in trust for its members. Common land for grazing, foraging, and ritual was a feature of every system.

Colonial codification displaced communal tenure from legal recognition. The colonial state introduced freehold title through English property law. The colonial mining and oil regimes enclosed subsurface rights in the colonial state (the Mineral Oils Act 1914 vested all mineral rights in the British Crown, transferred to the Nigerian state at independence). The colonial agricultural export economy enclosed land for cash crops (cocoa in the West, palm oil in the East, groundnut and cotton in the North).

Post-independence replication continued the displacement. The Land Use Act 1978 (a military decree by Obasanjo) vested all land in state governors, displacing the customary land tenure systems in favour of a Certificate of Occupancy system that requires state approval and payment. The Structural Adjustment Programme (SAP) of 1986 imposed user fees on public hospitals and began the slow enclosure of public education. The privatisation programmes of the 1990s and 2000s enclosed state-owned enterprises (NEPA, NITEL, refineries). The prepaid meter enclosed electricity. The data charge enclosed the internet. The BVN and NIN enclosed identity.

The tipping point in popular living memory: **circa 1978 for land** (Land Use Act), **circa 1986 for public services** (SAP), **circa 2000s for data and identity**. For Nigerians born after 1960 — the post-independence generation — Enclosure has 'always been' in its current form. They cannot recall a time when public healthcare was free, when public universities charged no tuition, when land was held communally without Certificate of Occupancy.

The pre-enclosure generation (born ~1940s-1950s) was the last to have living memory of free public healthcare in the 1970s, of free university tuition, of communal land tenure before the 1978 Act. By the 1990s, the SAP-induced enclosure of public services had become the natural order. By the 2010s, the prepaid meter, the data charge, the BVN, and the NIN had become the natural order. The question 'is private property natural?' had stopped being asked in popular memory by the 1980s. The question 'are user fees natural?' stopped being asked by the 1990s. The question 'is data enclosure natural?' stopped being asked by the 2010s.

SECTION 7

7. Fill in the Blank: A Self-Examination

The framework asks two questions of every subject of every ascended matrix. The blanks are for you. They are not rhetorical. The point of the framework is not to understand Enclosure in the abstract. It is to locate yourself inside it, so that the next time the triad assembles around you — or around someone whose access to resources does not fit the property model — you can see it.

Question 1: When did Enclosure rewrite your reality?

When did the system teach you that you could not rebel? The moment was: _____. The year was: _____. The institution or person who first made you feel that challenging the rent, the wage, the bill, the fee, or the data charge was impossible was: _____. The place was: _____. What you wanted to say but did not was: _____. What you did instead was: _____. What you told yourself about why you did not say it was: _____. The enclosed resource at the centre of the moment was: _____. The form of payment you performed was: _____. What you lost, in that moment, that you have not got back since, was: _____.

Question 2: How is Enclosure causing your Death?

How is the system shortening your life right now? The form of Death I am most afraid of from Enclosure is (fast/slow): _____. The specific way it is happening in my body is: _____. (For example: the chronic stress from years of rent burden; the insomnia from years of swallowing the rent increase; the loss of confidence from years of being told I am lucky to have a job; the breakdown I had in 20__ that I have never fully recovered from; the relationship I lost because I could not stop working to afford the rent; the medical diagnosis I now live with because I could not afford treatment earlier; the data that ran out mid-conversation with the person I needed to talk to; the eviction that displaced me and my family; the IDP camp where food is rationed.) The matrix's name for what is happening to me is: _____. My own name for it is: _____.

If you filled in the blanks honestly, you have just located yourself inside Enclosure. The next time the triad assembles — the next time the landlord demands, the next time the wage is paid, the next time the bill is collected, the next time the data runs out — you will be able to see the system moving through you. That sight is the beginning of abolition. And if you are now the enforcer in the triad — the landlord, the employer, the creditor, the billing officer — the sight is also the beginning of your refusal to enforce.

SECTION 8

8. Endnotes & References

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Coming Next

Chapter 8 will take up Productivism / Compulsory Productivity — the system that ranks productive activity above all other forms of human being, enforces work as the condition of social standing, and extracts labour, time, and bodily capacity from everyone it can reach. Productivism overlaps with Enclosure at the wage relationship (Chapter 7) and with Rankism at the workplace hierarchy (Chapter 2). The framework separates them so that the productivity logic specifically can be studied and dismantled.

If you are reading this chapter as part of the framework in progress, the order continues: Chapter 9 is Invasion, Chapter 10 is Settler Colonialism, Chapter 11 is Coloniality, and so on through the Fundamental Matrices. Each chapter follows the same template established in Chapters 2 through 7. The naive approach in the first three domains. The Ascension Ritual in the fourth. The historical memory trace. The fill-in-the-blank. The endnotes. The pattern is now set.